

Internship Candidate Assessment

Project Kestrel – Research Task

Competitive landscape table

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Short Memo

To: The Team, Newmoon Capital

From: Stuartt Lee Gregory

Date: April 2, 2026

Re: Project Kestrel — Competitive Landscape, Shah Alam ECE Corridor

a. What did you find?

My research identified 58 early childhood education (ECE) operators across the target corridor. The landscape is broadly split between Islamic-integrated programs (58.6%) and secular/international models (41.4%). The market is highly fragmented but geographically concentrated; Setia Alam (U13) acts as the primary hub with 17 operators, whereas fringe areas like U12 show minimal density. Pricing across the corridor averages RM523 per month, representing a wide spread from accessible RM300 options to RM1,700 premium campuses.

b. Who are the biggest threats to Target?

Out of the 58 operators, only two represent a high-level threat to the Target: Mahir Dhuha International Islamic Preschool (Bukit Jelutong) and Al-Kauthar Eduqids (Bukit Jelutong and Setia Alam branches). These operators are the biggest threats because their positioning directly overlaps with the Target's proposition of Islamic-integrated and internationally accredited curricula. With Target Brand B positioned at RM1,175/month—well above the RM523 market average—it will have to directly out-compete these specific, established players on visible quality and outcomes to justify its premium pricing.

c. Anything surprising?

The most striking finding was the religious orientation split. While the Target's strategy caters heavily to Malay-Muslim families, secular and international curricula still maintain a remarkably strong 41.4% foothold in this specific Shah Alam corridor. Additionally, the sheer volume of low-to-medium threat operators (56 out of 58) highlights an incredibly cluttered lower-tier market, suggesting parents face decision fatigue at the accessible price point.

d. Your overall read.

The competitive landscape looks manageable for Target. While the accessible tier is crowded, Target's premium Brand B has a clear runway to capture market share. By leveraging its eco-Islamic Cambridge positioning and focusing on the high-density Setia Alam (U13)

demographic, the Target can successfully differentiate itself from the noise of the 56 lower-tier competitors.